

Mini Master Degree Syllabus

Practical Applications of AI

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Mini Master Degree Program Information

Description

The Mini-Master Degree Program in Practical AI is a hands-on learning experience designed for ambitious professionals ready to harness artificial intelligence to expand their capabilities, productivity, and career growth drastically.

This program will multiply your output by 10x.

The program dives straight into real-world applications of AI across core business workflows: from strategy and operations to content creation, decision-making, and personal productivity. Across concentrated, high-value sessions, participants explore how to build and deploy AI-augmented systems, workflows, and tools that immediately add value to their day-to-day work, such as responding to emails, scheduling meetings, and reengineering systems.

Throughout the program, you will build critical *skills* in prompt design, agentic thinking, workflow automation, tool stacking, data-informed decision-making, and practical AI integration. More importantly, you will develop *competencies* at the intersection of business leadership and AI, including strategic thinking, operational redesign, navigating change, cross-functional influence, ethical judgment, and executing innovation.

Each class provides frameworks and hands-on exercises that push you beyond passive learning and will enable you to architect your own AI-augmented “personal consulting firm” to support your work.

By the end of the program, you will know how to intelligently integrate AI into your workflows to reclaim dozens of hours each month and convert that time into higher-value tasks that increase your visibility, impact, and business results.

You will walk away with your own personalized agents, ways to integrate them into your work and life, a broader understanding of AI capabilities, and how to leverage those capabilities to give you time back to do the things you love, not the mundane things you hate.

You will design your own multi-agent workflow and learn how to build AI-powered dashboards, client deliverables, decision-support systems, and execution assistants. You will not simply gain familiarity with popular tools like ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, ElevenLabs, Gamma, Augment, MindStudio, Synthesia,

and others; you will understand how to *combine* them into end-to-end automations that deliver compounding value.

Participants leave this experience with a strategic blueprint to future-proof their career and become indispensable in the age of AI. You will walk away with the mindset, capabilities, and systems to multiply yourself by 10, not by working harder or spending more time in your office (or running life chores!), but by working exponentially *smarter* through AI augmentation.

Who should take this program?

This Mini-Master Program is designed for solopreneurs, consultants, creators, HR and people leaders, and professionals inside organizations who want to reclaim time and replace overwhelming, repetitive work with their own AI-built support systems. It is ideal for anyone ready to move beyond curiosity and actually build a personal AI workforce, from executive assistants to research agents to content engines, that strengthens how they run their business or role. Whether you're growing a consulting practice, scaling a side project, or redesigning how you operate in your day-to-day work, this program is for ambitious individuals who want practical, hands-on results and a fully functioning AI system they can rely on.

Mini Master Degree Program Guidelines

The Mini Master Degree Program [Guidelines](#) provide a complete overview of everything you need to maximize your learning experience. From general policies to detailed information on class schedules, post-class activities, and assessment criteria, these guidelines serve as your central reference for understanding the program's structure, expectations, and opportunities for professional and personal growth.

Top Skills

This section explains the top ten skills you will learn in this Mini Master Degree program.

AI Workforce Design & Deployment

Develop the ability to build and manage a personalized set of AI agents that take on research, reporting, follow-ups, onboarding tasks, proposals, and more.

AI-Connected Automation Systems

Develop the ability to design automated workflows that handle email sequences, reminders, document creation, and daily operational tasks with consistency and accuracy.

AI-Driven Professional Output & Communication

Develop the ability to turn ideas into polished proposals, strategy decks, memos, onboarding materials, and briefs quickly and effectively using AI tools.

Content Creation & Visibility with AI Tools

Develop the ability to produce high-quality written and visual content—including posts, articles, newsletters, and short videos—that elevates your professional presence.

AI-Enabled Research & Insight Development

Develop the ability to use AI agents for market scanning, competitive analysis, and insight extraction that strengthens clarity, direction, and decision-making.

Integrated AI Operating System Design

Develop the ability to create a cohesive AI system that connects agents, automations, and tools into one workflow that reflects how you think and work.

Personal AI Training & Customization

Develop the ability to customize AI agents so they adapt to your style, preferences, routines, and priorities for more accurate and meaningful output.

Workflow Mapping & AI Toolchain Design

Develop the ability to map your processes and assemble the right mix of AI tools that support the way you work from start to finish.

Custom Agent Development & System Expansion

Develop the ability to create custom GPTs and specialized agents that extend your capabilities and strengthen your personal or professional workflow.

AI-Augmented Time and Priority Management

Develop the ability to structure your day using AI support that keeps tasks organized, reduces cognitive load, and helps you concentrate on work that matters most.

Functional Areas and Competency Framework

We provide a structured and comprehensive competency framework as part of this Mini Master's Degree program.

This competency framework defines the essential skills required for success in the corresponding functional area (or class).

Functional Area 1: The Big Idea: Why AI Is Your First Hire

This class covers the concept of AI as a multiplier of human effort. You'll learn how to shift your mindset, audit your time, and identify where AI can help you reclaim capacity and drive impact in both life and work.

Learning objectives:

1. How to reframe AI as a strategic "first hire" in your personal and professional life.
2. How to conduct a personal time audit to reveal areas where AI can add value.
3. How to identify high-impact opportunities for AI integration.
4. How to use AI to reclaim capacity and focus on higher-value work.

Functional Area 2: Building Your First Smart Agent

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab guides you through building a simple AI agent to handle a specific, real-world task from your work or life, using tools like ChatGPT and MindStudio.

Learning objectives:

1. How to identify a task that can be effectively handled by an AI agent.
2. How to select and use beginner-friendly AI tools for agent creation.
3. How to set up your agent to complete the task successfully.
4. How to refine your agent through collaborative feedback from peers.

Functional Area 3: AI as Your Personal Operating System

This class covers how to develop a system of AI tools and workflows that work for you, enabling you to process information, generate outputs, and manage day-to-day tasks with less effort and greater consistency.

Learning objectives:

1. How to design a personal AI-powered system for daily operations.
2. How to streamline information processing with AI tools.
3. How to improve output generation for consistency and quality.
4. How to integrate AI seamlessly into your work and personal routines.

Functional Area 4: Automation for Everyday Life

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab helps you design simple automations to streamline recurring activities (e.g., email triage, scheduling, weekly summaries) and explore how to reduce mental load by outsourcing low-value thinking.

Learning objectives:

1. How to identify repetitive activities that are prime for automation.
2. How to design simple AI-powered automations for everyday use.
3. How to test and improve automations for efficiency and accuracy.
4. How to share and adapt automation ideas through group collaboration.

Functional Area 5: Designing Your AI Stack: Tools, Layers, Logic

This class covers how to structure your AI infrastructure: understanding tool types, how they connect, and how to evaluate what's worth your time to learn or build.

Learning objectives:

1. How to identify the core components of an effective AI stack.
2. How to connect different AI tools for cohesive workflows.
3. How to evaluate AI tools for functionality and ROI.
4. How to strategically select which tools to adopt or build.

Functional Area 6: Workflow Mapping + AI Toolchain Building

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab walks you through mapping one complete workflow (from start to finish) and plugging in AI tools to reduce time, friction, or effort with real-time feedback and coaching.

Learning objectives:

1. How to visually map an entire workflow from start to finish.
2. How to identify workflow steps that AI can improve or automate.
3. How to assemble an AI toolchain for a specific workflow.
4. How to refine your design through collaborative problem-solving.

Functional Area 7: AI for Thinking, Not Just Doing

This class covers how to use AI as a thinking partner: generating insights, breaking creative blocks, helping you reason through decisions, and sparking better questions.

Learning objectives:

1. How to leverage AI for deeper insights and better decision-making.
2. How to use AI to overcome creative blocks.
3. How to improve problem-solving with AI-assisted reasoning.
4. How to enhance your questioning skills with AI prompts and responses.

Functional Area 8: Using AI to Level Up Your Content + Communication

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab explores use cases where AI helps you write, summarize, script, design, storyboard, and polish content for both personal and professional use.

Learning objectives:

1. How to use AI for a variety of content creation tasks.
2. How to improve writing quality, tone, and clarity with AI tools.
3. How to design visual and multimedia content using AI.
4. How to exchange tips and feedback to enhance content outputs

Functional Area 9: Building Intelligent Systems: Foundations of AI Agents

This class covers the building blocks of AI agents: memory, goals, logic, tool use, and reflection, and introduces how they can extend your reach even further.

Learning objectives:

1. How AI agents use memory, goals, and logic to operate effectively.
2. How to integrate tool use into AI agent design.
3. How reflection loops improve AI agent performance.
4. How to identify opportunities to apply AI agents in real-world contexts.

Functional Area 10: Advanced Agent Simulation

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab challenges you to test a multi-step agent use case from your own life or work, simulating the internal “thinking loop” and iterating on the prompts, workflows, or data inputs.

Learning objectives:

1. How to design multi-step tasks for AI agents.
2. How to simulate and observe the internal decision-making process of an agent.
3. How to troubleshoot and improve agent logic and workflows.
4. How to adapt designs based on group testing and peer suggestions

Functional Area 11: Designing for Efficiency and Delight: AI in Daily Experience

This class covers how to optimize the interfaces, inputs, and outputs in your AI tools so they integrate naturally into your routines and make life easier.

Learning objectives:

1. How to simplify user interfaces for better AI tool adoption.
2. How to refine AI inputs for faster, higher-quality outputs.
3. How to create outputs that are actionable and aligned with needs.
4. How to ensure AI tools enhance rather than complicate workflows

Functional Area 12: Restructuring a Day with AI

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab walks you through a full-day redesign, analyzing how you spend time, then using AI to reduce decision fatigue, prep content, schedule smartly, and free up space.

Learning objectives:

1. How to audit and analyze your current daily time allocation.
2. How to identify opportunities to optimize your day with AI tools.
3. How to implement AI to manage scheduling, preparation, and follow-up.
4. How to share and iterate designs based on group experiences.

Functional Area 13: Setting Up Guardrails: Privacy, Bias, and Safe Use of AI

This class covers where AI can go wrong, how to stay safe with your data, and how to set personal standards for using AI responsibly in your work and life

Learning objectives:

1. How to recognize and mitigate AI-related risks.
2. How to protect personal and organizational data when using AI.
3. How to identify and reduce AI bias.

4. How to create a personal AI usage standard and ethical framework

Functional Area 14: Building Your AI Charter

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab helps you craft a simple set of principles and filters to guide how, when, and where you use AI, building a framework that helps you stay intentional.

Learning objectives:

1. How to define personal principles for AI use.
2. How to create filters for deciding when to use AI.
3. How to balance AI efficiency with ethical considerations.
4. How to collaborate on charter design for stronger outcomes.

Functional Area 15: Personalizing AI: Training It to Know You

This class covers simple ways to train your AI tools to understand your tone, preferences, routines, and needs, and how to build context-rich systems that learn with you.

Learning objectives:

1. How to customize AI tools to align with your communication style.
2. How to incorporate personal routines into AI workflows.
3. How to embed preferences for more accurate AI outputs.
4. How to design systems that adapt and improve over time.

Functional Area 16: Custom GPT + MindStudio Agent Building

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab walks you through creating and testing a personal or professional AI Agent, making it both powerful and user-friendly.

Learning objectives:

1. How to design a GPT or agent tailored to your needs.
2. How to integrate personalization into your agent's capabilities.
3. How to test and refine your GPT or agent for usability and impact.

4. How to learn from group demonstrations and feedback.

Functional Area 17: Scaling Yourself Without Burning Out

This class covers how to use AI to protect your time, reduce stress, and stay focused. This session helps you build a sustainable system that supports your whole life.

Learning objectives:

1. How to use AI to reduce workload without sacrificing quality.
2. How to avoid overcomplicating workflows with too many tools.
3. How to design AI systems that prioritize mental well-being.
4. How to create sustainable AI-enabled work practices.

Functional Area 18: Final Systems Integration Lab

This facilitated, peer-to-peer lab supports you in finalizing your AI infrastructure: connecting tools, streamlining handoffs, building dashboards, and rehearsing full use-case execution in your chosen domain.

Learning objectives:

1. How to integrate multiple AI tools into a unified system.
2. How to optimize handoffs between AI tools for efficiency.
3. How to design and customize AI dashboards for visibility and control.
4. How to practice real-world execution with peer review and feedback.

Functional Area 19: Your AI-Augmented Life + Work Strategy

This class covers how to develop a roadmap for continued experimentation, skill growth and evolution so your AI practice keeps leveling up with you.

Learning objectives:

1. How to build a forward-looking AI integration plan.
2. How to identify emerging AI tools and trends worth exploring.
3. How to set measurable goals for AI skill development.
4. How to keep your AI practice adaptable and future-ready

Class Topics and Schedule

Refer to the class schedule on the website and dashboard for specific meeting dates and times.

Activity and assignment details will be explained in detail within each week's corresponding learning module.

If you have any questions, please contact Danielle at danielle@hackinghr.io

- Week 1: The Big Idea: Why AI Is Your First Hire
- Week 2: Building Your First Smart Agent
- Week 3: AI as Your Personal Operating System
- Week 4: Automation for Everyday Life
- Week 5: Designing Your AI Stack: Tools, Layers, Logic
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